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1.0 Product / Service Ideation

1.1 Discuss Your Idea

Many elderly individuals struggle with daily activities, social isolation, and adapting to modern technology, which reduces their independence and overall well-being. At the same time, individuals who want to volunteer often find it difficult to connect with seniors who need help in a structured and reliable manner.

ElderEase is a digital platform designed to bridge the gap between seniors in need of assistance and volunteers willing to help. The platform allows seniors to request support for everyday tasks such as grocery shopping, medical appointments, and learning digital skills, while volunteers can easily find and accept tasks based on their availability.

Key Features:

- **User-Friendly Interface:** Simple navigation for elderly users with easy request submission.
- **Volunteer Matching System:** Connects seniors with available volunteers based on location and assistance type.
- **Task Tracking and Status Updates:** Seniors and volunteers can track task progress in real-time.
- **Safety & Trust Mechanisms:** Includes identity verification and rating systems to ensure reliability.
- **Digital Literacy Support:** Provides tutorials and guidance to help seniors adapt to technology.

ElderEase is valuable because it fosters a mutually beneficial relationship between seniors and volunteers, promoting independence and social connectivity for the elderly while providing structured and meaningful volunteering opportunities.

For seniors:

- Increases access to essential support.
- Reduces social isolation.
- Empowers them to stay independent longer.

For volunteers:

- Provides a flexible way to contribute.
- Allows tracking of contributions for motivation.
- Strengthens intergenerational connections.

By creating a supportive and inclusive community, ElderEase enhances the well-being of seniors while promoting social responsibility among volunteers.

1.2 Generate Ideas

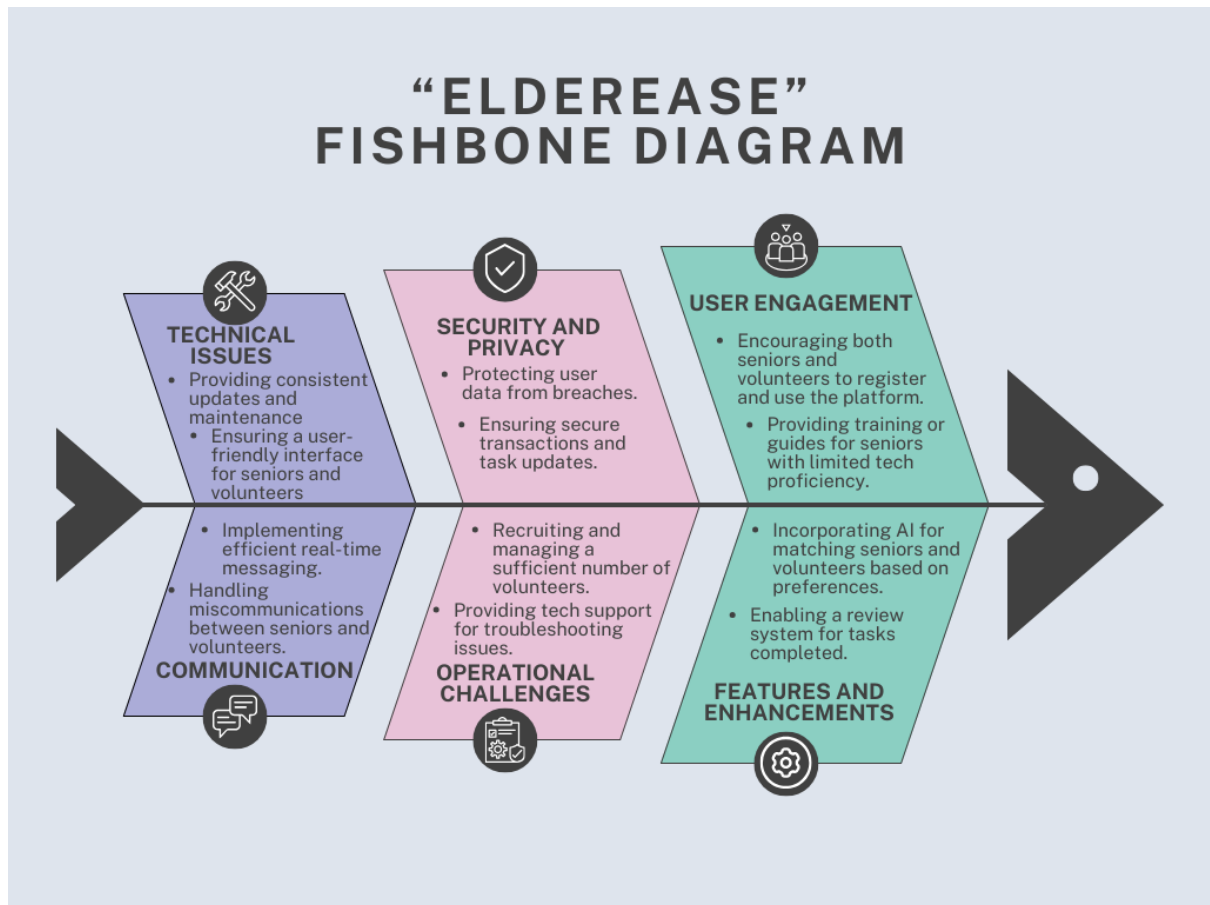
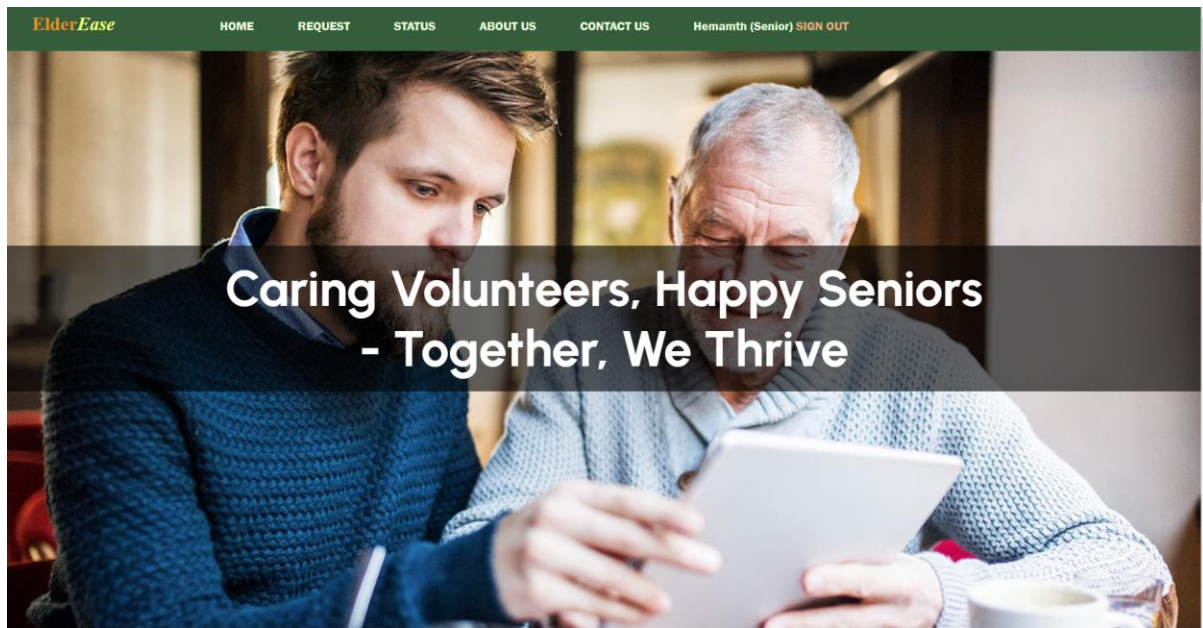


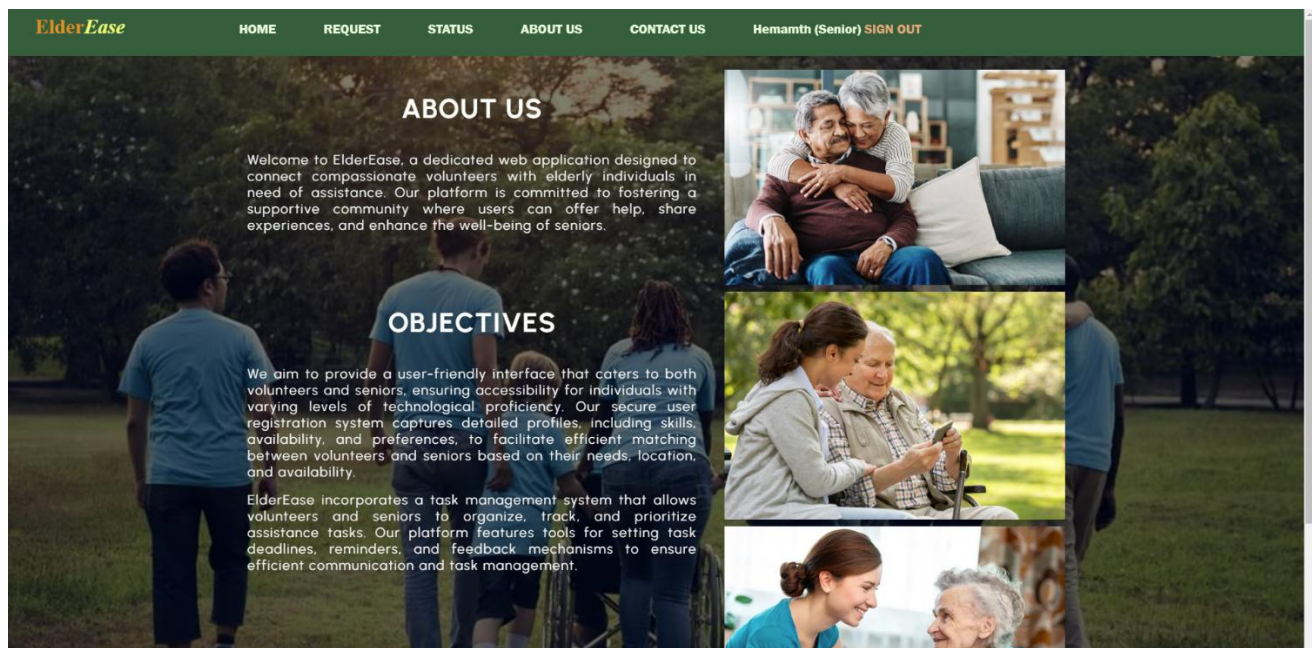
Figure 1: ElderEase Fishbone Diagram

2.0 Create a Prototype

2.1 Develop a Prototype



Screen Name	Home Page
User(s)	Registered Users, Unregistered Users
Description	Users can view the homepage, which shows the purpose of ElderEase which is connecting volunteers with seniors. The banner message emphasizes community support and assistance.



Screen Name	About Us Page
User(s)	Registered Users, Unregistered Users
Description	Users can read about ElderEase's mission and objectives. The page explains how the platform supports elderly individuals by connecting them with volunteers and facilitating assistance.

ElderEase HOME REQUEST STATUS ABOUT US CONTACT US Hemamth (Senior) SIGN OUT

Feel Free To Contact Us

Contact Us

Company email: ElderEase@mail.my
 Company tel: +601116665060
 Street: 21 Jln 8/1D Seksyen 8 Petaling Jaya
 City: Petaling Jaya
 State/province/area: Selangor
 Zip code: 46050

Tell us how we can improve

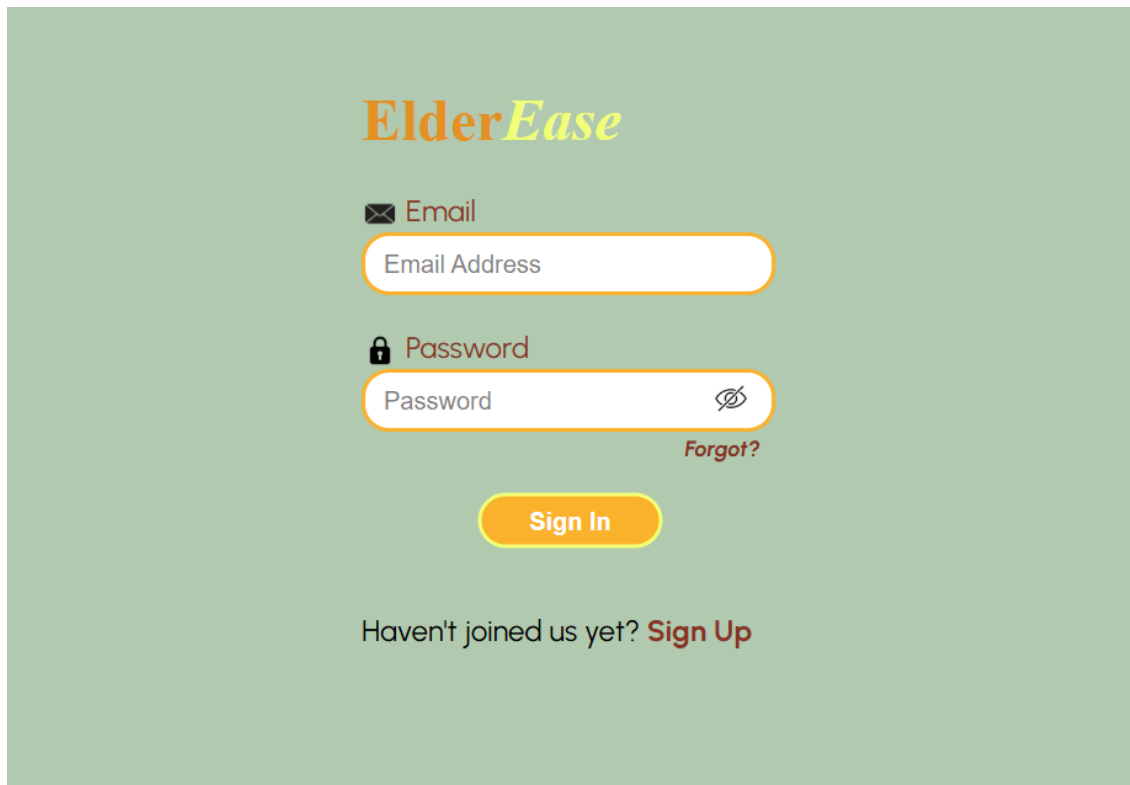
Email

Phone Number

Feedback

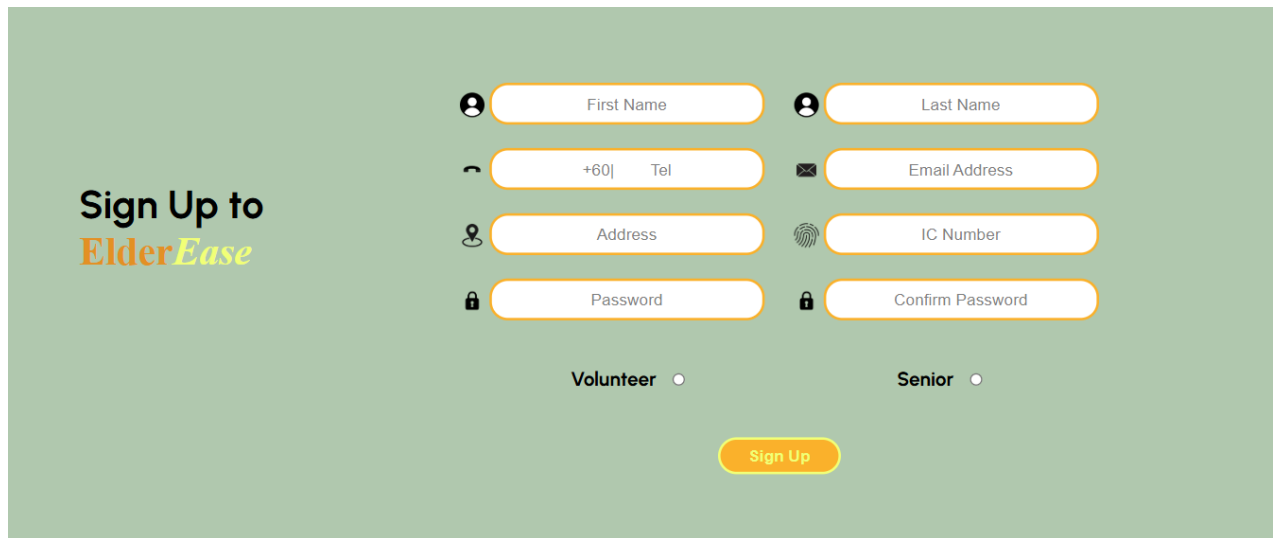
Submit

Screen Name	Contact Us Page
User(s)	Registered Users, Unregistered Users
Description	Users can find the contact details of ElderEase, including email, phone number, and address. A feedback form is also available for users to provide suggestions or request assistance.



The image shows a sign-in page for 'ElderEase'. The background is a solid light green. At the top center is the logo 'ElderEase' in a bold, sans-serif font, with 'Elder' in orange and 'Ease' in yellow. Below the logo are two input fields. The first is labeled 'Email' with an envelope icon and contains the placeholder text 'Email Address'. The second is labeled 'Password' with a lock icon and contains the placeholder text 'Password'. To the right of the password field is an eye icon for toggling visibility. Below the password field is a link that says 'Forgot?'. Centered below these fields is a yellow rounded rectangular button with the text 'Sign In' in black. At the bottom of the form area is the text 'Haven't joined us yet? Sign Up', where 'Sign Up' is in a bold, dark red font.

Screen Name	Sign In Page
User(s)	Registered Users
Description	Users can enter their email and password to log into ElderEase. There is also an option to reset a forgotten password and a link to sign up for new users.



Sign Up to ElderEase

First Name Last Name

+60| Tel Email Address

Address IC Number

Password Confirm Password

Volunteer ☐ Senior ☐

Sign Up

Screen Name	Sign Up Page
User(s)	Unregistered Users
Description	New users can register by providing their first and last name, phone number, email, address, identification card number, and password. Users must also select their role (Volunteer or Senior) before completing the sign-up process.

ForgotPassword

Please enter your Identification Card (IC) number and your email address used to sign up for verification purposes. We greatly appreciate your cooperation

 IC Number

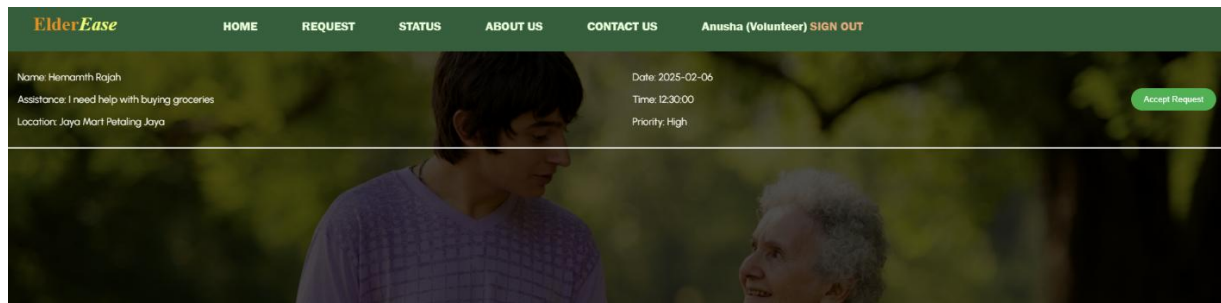
Identification Card Number

 Email

Email Address

Verify

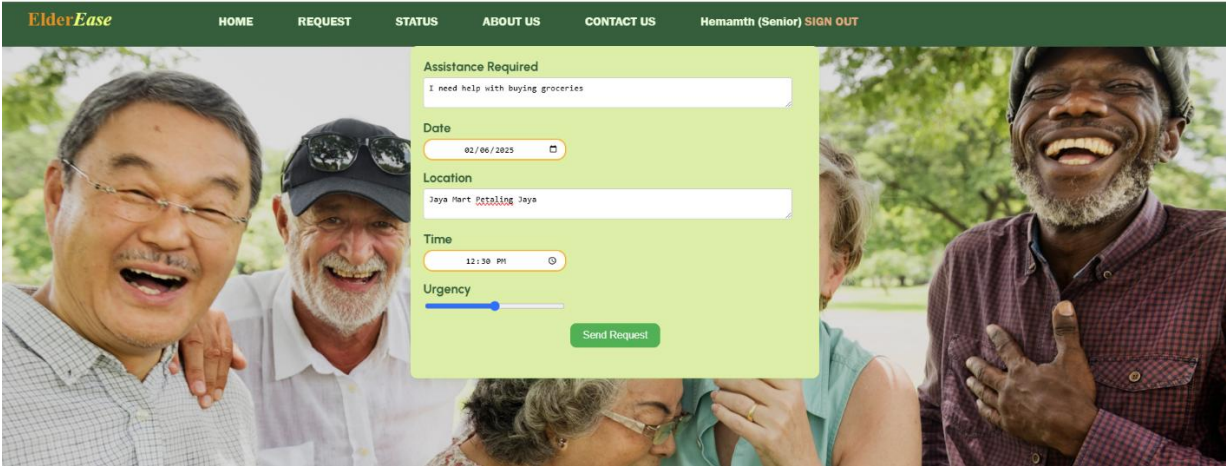
Screen Name	Forgot Password Page
User(s)	Registered Users
Description	Users who forgot their password can enter their IC number and email address for verification. Upon successful verification, they can reset their password.



Screen Name	Request Page
User(s)	Volunteers
Description	Displays details of a help request from a senior, including their name, type of assistance needed, location, date, time, and priority level. Volunteers can accept the request using the "Accept Request" button.

Name	Details	Date/Time	Location	Completion
Hemamth Rajah	I need help with buying groceries	2025-02-06 12:30:00	Jaya Mart Petaling Jaya	Pending

Screen Name	Status Page
User(s)	Volunteers
Description	Shows the list of tasks assigned to the volunteer, including details like requester name, assistance details, date/time, location, and completion status. Volunteers can track pending and completed tasks.



Screen Name	Request Page
User(s)	Seniors
Description	Seniors can submit a request for assistance by entering details such as the type of help required, date, location, time, and urgency level. The request is then sent to available volunteers.

ElderEase HOME REQUEST STATUS ABOUT US CONTACT US Hemamth (Senior) SIGN OUT				
Name	Details	Date/Time	Location	Completion
Anusha Devy	I need help with buying groceries	2025-02-06 12:30:00	Jaya Mart Petaling Jaya	Complete
Anusha Devy	I need help picking up meds from the Hospital	2025-02-06 10:30:00	Sunway Medical Centre	Pending

Screen Name	Status Page
User(s)	Seniors
Description	Displays a list of requests made by the senior, along with details like assistance type, date/time, location, and completion status. Seniors can track whether their requests are pending or completed.

2.2 Test Your Prototype

We carried out thorough evaluation sessions that combined structured interviews and direct user testing to make sure ElderEase meets the needs of volunteers and seniors. Our goal was to collect useful information so that the platform could be enhanced.

Feedback Collection Process

1. Participant Recruitment:

- **Seniors:** Three seniors that fit our intended demographic were recruited. These people indicated a desire for help with everyday duties.
- **Volunteers:** Five volunteers who were interested in giving back to their communities were invited, they included both university students and working professionals.

2. Testing Environment:

- We created a controlled environment where participants could explore a working prototype of the ElderEase platform.
- The testing sessions were conducted both in-person (community centers) and remotely (via video conferencing) to accommodate the preferences of our participants.

3. Methods Used:

- **Observation:** Participants were observed as they navigated the platform. Their interactions were analyzed to identify usability challenges and points of friction.
- **Surveys:** Both seniors and volunteers completed post-session surveys to rate their experience on specific aspects of the platform.
- **Interviews:** Follow-up interviews were conducted to gain a deeper understanding of participant experiences and suggestions for improvement.

List of Questions Proposed:

1. Seniors

- **Ease of Use:**
 - a. Were you able to navigate the platform without difficulty?
 - b. Did you find the interface intuitive and clear?
- **Relevance:**
 - c. Did the platform offer services that would help with your daily needs?
 - d. Were you able to find suitable volunteers for your requests?
- **Comfort and Trust:**
 - e. Did you feel comfortable using the platform to connect with volunteers?
 - f. What features could increase your sense of safety and trust?
- **Additional Features:**
 - g. What additional services or support would you like the platform to offer?
 - h. Are there any aspects of the platform that you found confusing or unnecessary?

2. Volunteers

- **Ease of Use:**
 - a. Were you able to set up your profile and browse requests easily?
 - b. Did you find the process of selecting and accepting tasks straightforward?
- **Motivation:**
 - c. Did the platform make you feel encouraged to participate?
 - d. Was the volunteer tracking feature helpful in motivating you?
- **Impact Assessment:**
 - a. Do you feel the platform provided meaningful opportunities to contribute?
 - b. How likely are you to continue using ElderEase? Why or why not?
- **Suggestions:**
 - c. Are there any features or services you'd like to see added?
 - d. What challenges did you face while using the platform?

3.0 Identify Customers

3.1 Create Personas

1. Mr. Adam (Senior, 70s)

- **Background:** Mr. Adam is a retired schoolteacher who dedicated his life educating students in his neighborhood. He lives alone in a little apartment after his wife passed away a few years ago. Though he is autonomous, he sometimes struggles with everyday duties owing to mobility limitations.
- **Personality:** Warm-hearted, patient, and a bit old-fashioned. He cherishes generosity and enjoys imparting wisdom with future generations.
- **Technology Proficiency:** Moderate. He can browse the internet and send emails but finds newer digital platforms bewildering.
- **Motivation for Using ElderEase:** He wants a reliable way to seek help for routine activities like grocery shopping, medication pickups, or modest house repairs without feeling like a burden to his busy neighbors or family members.

Challenges:

- Struggles with grasping current technology.
- Hesitates to ask for help, feeling terrible about being dependent.

2. Samantha (Volunteer, 25)

- **Background:** Samantha is a university student studying social work. She has a tremendous love for helping people and has always been active in community service. She grew up close to her grandparents and appreciates the value of aiding the elderly.
- **Personality:** Compassionate, active, and tech-savvy. She is continuously looking for meaningful ways to give back to society.
- **Technology Proficiency:** Advanced. She navigates apps and webpages effortlessly and loves using digital platforms for arranging work.
- **Motivation for Using ElderEase:** She wants to use her free time to make a difference in her community. She finds satisfaction in serving seniors and feels that tiny acts of kindness can change lives.

Challenges:

- Balancing her volunteer job with her studies.
- Ensuring that seniors feel comfortable and valued when she helps them.

3. Admin (Website Administrator, 35-45 years old)

- **Background:** The ElderEase Admin is an IT specialist who runs the website and guarantees smooth interactions between seniors and volunteers. They work behind the scenes, addressing user registrations, technological challenges, and security concerns.
- **Personality:** Logical, problem-solving, and efficient. They take pleasure in keeping a secure and user-friendly platform.
- **Technology Proficiency:** Expert. They are responsible for addressing technological issues, increasing system functionality, and updating the platform depending on user feedback.
- **Motivation for Running ElderEase:** They passionately believe in leveraging technology to bridge generational gaps and make life easier for seniors. They appreciate seeing real-life success stories of volunteers making a difference.

Challenges:

- Ensuring platform security to prevent scams or misuse.
- Making the system accessible to elders with various levels of tech literacy.

3.2 Read and Research Market

ElderEase seeks to link seniors requiring assistance with caring volunteers, creating a community that promotes independence and well-being. To best serve this audience, we performed market research to identify target users, segment the market, and estimate its potential size. This research guarantees that the platform meets user needs and objectives effectively.

The audience for ElderEase can be categorized into three main groups. The first group consists of seniors in need of assistance, like Puan Siti Aishah, a retired teacher managing arthritis and living alone. These individuals require support with daily tasks, companionship, and basic technology help to maintain their independence and stay connected within their communities. The second group includes volunteers such as Amir Hakim, a university student dedicated to community service who seeks flexible opportunities to contribute while appreciating platforms that track his impact. Lastly are the working professionals pressed for time—like Cik Nurul Ain, a nurse and single mother—who desire volunteering options that accommodate their busy schedules while also inspiring others.

The potential market size for ElderEase is significant. The Total Addressable Market (TAM) encompasses all seniors in Malaysia, with an estimated 3.5 million individuals aged 60 and above, plus around 1 million active volunteers. Narrowing the focus to seniors and volunteers residing in urban and suburban areas with internet access defines the Serviceable Addressable Market (SAM), totaling approximately 2.7 million people. Initially aiming to capture a share of this SAM, ElderEase plans to reach about 270,000 users—or roughly 10%—as its Serviceable Obtainable Market (SOM), concentrating on regions such as Selangor, Kuala Lumpur, Johor, and Melaka.

This research highlights both opportunities and challenges. It points out that seniors frequently encounter difficulties with digital literacy, emphasizing the need for user-friendly designs and tutorials on the platform. Community-driven solutions resonate with professionals who seek flexible and meaningful involvement. On the other hand, younger volunteers, especially students, form a motivated group eager to make connections and gain knowledge through their experiences.

In summary, this market research highlights a significant demand for ElderEase among both seniors and volunteers. By catering to the unique needs of these groups and harnessing digital trends, the platform can effectively secure its initial market share and facilitate further growth, fostering independence, community support, and social connections.

4.0 Conclusion

ElderEase is an innovative platform created to serve the growing requirements of elderly and volunteers in modern society. By connecting older folks with compassionate volunteers, the platform not only provides necessary help for seniors but also offers volunteers a meaningful opportunity to contribute to their communities. Through extensive brainstorming, prototyping, and testing processes, ElderEase has improved its concept to ensure accessibility, ease of use, and a positive experience for both seniors and volunteers.

The construction of user personas such as Mr. Adam, a senior needing aid with daily duties, and Samantha, a volunteer ready to give back to the community, highlights the different and linked requirements that ElderEase caters to. By identifying the challenges faced by seniors, such as digital literacy and emotions of dependency, ElderEase attempts to bridge this gap with a user-friendly interface and features meant to improve safety, trust, and confidence in the platform.

Market study confirms the enormous demand for such a service, with a sizeable potential market in Malaysia, consisting of millions of elders and active volunteers. ElderEase's approach to reach its target audience by focusing on urban and suburban areas with internet connection is well-aligned with the demands of both elders and volunteers, ensuring that the platform's growth is sustainable and scalable.

In conclusion, ElderEase is positioned to make a major impact on boosting the quality of life for seniors while simultaneously promoting community engagement. Its meticulous design, combined with continual testing and market research, ensures that it fits the needs of its users and stands out as a valuable tool for building intergenerational connection, support, and inclusivity. As ElderEase continues to expand, it has the potential to revolutionize the way we think about caring and volunteerism in modern society, producing a more connected and compassionate community for all.

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Video Presentation Link:

https://cloudmails-my.sharepoint.com/:v:/g/personal/tp071154_mail_apu_edu_my/Eb41nlgQtklJu3Rgh0T8iwsB6ZbK1OLhF0KTe5z7CjBGRA?e=2PMn9k